Data Across Industries

BY THE END:

You can explain how data skills are used in different industries and why domain knowledge matters.

Overview

A clinic, a money transfer service, and a school can use the same data skills. The tools may be similar, but each place has different questions and different data.

Same skills, different questions

Across industries, people collect, clean, analyze, and explain data. The steps are similar. What changes is the problem they need to solve.

These are **transferable skills**: skills you can use in different jobs and industries.

Why domain knowledge matters

Domain knowledge means understanding how an industry works. It helps you ask useful questions, understand what the data means, and notice when a result does not make sense.

Data skills alone are not enough. An analyst working in a clinic needs to understand appointments and patient visits. In a money transfer service, the analyst needs to understand how transfers work and which rules the company follows.

Examples from different industries

INDUSTRY	EXAMPLE QUESTION	DOMAIN KNOWLEDGE NEEDED
Clinic	Which patients missed a follow-up visit?	Understanding appointments and patient visits
Money transfer	Which transfers should staff review?	Understanding normal transfers and review rules
School	Which students have started missing more classes?	Understanding attendance records and school days
Livestock and export	Why were some livestock shipments rejected during inspection?	Understanding inspection and export rules
Telecom	Which customers stopped buying airtime or data bundles?	Understanding airtime, data bundles, and customer activity
Water and electricity	Where is water or electricity being used but not correctly recorded?	Understanding meters and usage records
Wholesale and retail	Which products sell quickly, and which remain unsold?	Understanding sales and stock
Aid and public services	Which areas need more support?	Understanding local needs and available services

Data skills can be used in many industries. Domain knowledge helps you use those skills to ask the right questions and understand the answers.